



GALILEO'S THERMOMETERS

Around 1600, Galileo invented a “thermoscope.” This temperature-measuring device relied on his discovery that fluids change their density when they grow warmer or colder. His followers later used the principle to design a thermometer in which weighted glass balls rose or sank to reveal the temperature.



Replica of Galilean thermometer

CLASH WITH AUTHORITY

Galileo's teaching of a sun-centered universe put him in conflict with the powerful Catholic Church, which insisted on Biblical teachings that Earth was the center of everything. In his later years, Galileo was forced to defend his teachings when he was put on trial by the Inquisition (a church court). Found guilty of heresy, he spent the last 9 years of his life under house arrest near Florence, and died in 1642. In 1992, the Church formally recognized that Galileo was right.

1610

Galileo publishes *The Starry Messenger*, a book outlining his discoveries with the telescope. He argues for Copernicus's heliocentric (sun-centered) system rather than a geocentric (Earth-centered) one.

1615

At a Church inquisition (trial) in Rome, Galileo is ordered to stop teaching the Copernican theory of the universe.

1633

After publishing his *Dialogue Concerning the Two Chief World Systems*, Galileo is tried at another inquisition, and is sentenced for heresy.

1642

Galileo dies near Florence. Despite suffering blindness for the last 4 years of his life, he had continued to write and invent until his final year.